

From the Recipe Book of Rose Thornton

Scanned from Grandma Rose's handwritten binder. Bayonne, NJ. Transcribed as written.

Sunday Stew

Make it Sunday morning so the house smells right by 3 o'clock. Cynthia's favorite. Double it, somebody always shows up.

- 3 lb beef chuck or short rib, cut big
- 2 onions
- 4 carrots
- 3 ribs celery
- 6 little potatoes
- 2 spoons tomato paste
- 1 cup red wine (the everyday Zin)
- beef stock to cover
- 2 bay leaves, thyme
- salt, pepper, flour to dredge

1. Brown the meat hard in the cast iron. Don't rush it. Take it out.
2. Cook the onions till soft, add the tomato paste, let it darken.
3. Wine in, scrape the bottom. That's the flavor, don't waste it.
4. Meat back in, stock to cover, herbs. Low oven, 3 hours, lid on.
5. Last 45 minutes add the carrots, celery, potatoes.
6. Taste for salt at the end, never the start. Serve with bread to mop.

Pot Roast

Same idea, leaner cut. Tuesday food.

- 4 lb bottom round
- 2 onions
- garlic, whole cloves
- stock and a splash of wine
- carrots and potatoes

1. Sear, season, low and slow until a fork goes in easy.
 2. Rest before slicing or it all runs out.
 3. Skim the fat, make the gravy from the drippings.
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Grandma's Biscuits

Cold butter, fast hands. If your kitchen is hot, chill the bowl.

- 2 cups flour
- 1 spoon baking powder
- half spoon salt
- 1 stick cold butter
- three quarter cup buttermilk

1. Cut the cold butter into the flour till it's pea size.
 2. Buttermilk in, mix just until it comes together. Don't work it.
 3. Pat out, fold over twice for layers, cut straight down.
 4. Hot oven till golden. Butter while warm.
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Homemade Bread

Cynthia took this one and ran with it. Hers is fancier now but this is where it started.

- 4 cups flour
- 2 spoons yeast
- 1.5 cups warm water
- 1 spoon salt
- 1 spoon sugar
- oil for the bowl

1. Bloom the yeast in the warm water with the sugar.
 2. Mix in flour and salt, knead 10 minutes till smooth.
 3. Rise in an oiled bowl till doubled, about an hour.
 4. Shape, rise again, bake hot till it sounds hollow.
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Note in the margin (Cynthia's handwriting): "This binder is the whole reason. Rootstock starts here."